

# ZenithPro-Architecture-Quick-Start

## ZenithPro Architecture Quick Start

### Get Your AI Workspace Set Up Right

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## Three Things You Need to Know First

Before touching a single file, understand these three facts. They would have saved hours of frustration for everyone on last night's call.

#### 1. Claude navigates your entire folder structure automatically.

When you point Claude to a folder, it can see everything inside it -- every subfolder, every file, all the way down. You do NOT need to put everything in one folder. In fact, putting everything in one folder is the worst thing you can do.

#### 2. CLAUDE.md files are context markers.

When Claude enters a folder, the first thing it does is look for a file called `CLAUDE.md`. That file tells Claude what this folder is about, what's in it, and how to work with it. You can have one in every folder. Think of it as a sign on the door.

#### 3. Your `.claude` folder is your global brain.

There's a hidden folder on your Mac at `~/claude/` (or on Windows at `%USERPROFILE%\claude\`). This is where your skills, settings, and global CLAUDE.md live. It applies to every session, every project, everything. If this folder is empty or misconfigured, Claude starts every session knowing nothing about you.

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## Step 1: Check Your `.claude` Folder (5 minutes)

### Mac

Open Claude Code (terminal or desktop, either one) and say:

Check my `.claude` folder. Tell me: Do I have a global CLAUDE.md file? Do I have a skills folder with any skills in it? Do I have a settings.json file? Report what you find.

## What you should see:

- `~/claude/CLAUDE.md` -- your global instructions (if missing, we'll create it)
- `~/claude/skills/` -- folder with skill files (if empty, we'll fix it)
- `~/claude/settings.json` -- your permission settings (if missing, we'll create it)

If any of these are missing, don't panic. That's what we're fixing right now.

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## Step 2: Set Up Your Permission Rules (2 minutes)

This fixes the problem where Claude asks your permission for every single action. Say this to Claude:

I want to configure my permissions so you can work autonomously. Here are my rules:

ALLOW without asking: Read any file. Create new files. Edit existing files. Search my file system. Run shell commands. Install packages.

NEVER allow: Delete files permanently. Push code to remote repositories. Send emails or messages. Make purchases or sign up for services.

Set these up in my settings now.

After this, Claude should be able to work without asking you permission every 30 seconds.

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## Step 3: Organize Your Files (15 minutes)

If everything is in one folder right now, here's the fix. Say this to Claude:

I need to organize my AI workspace. Right now everything is in one folder and it's a mess. Here's what I want:

Create this structure in my Documents folder (keep my existing files, just organize them):

Documents/

[YourName]-AI/

CLAUDE.md

00-ZenithPro/ (course materials, lesson notes, exercises)

01-Projects/ (my actual AI projects, one subfolder per project)

02-Skills-Reference/ (skills and methodologies I've received)

03-Resources/ (reference materials, templates, research)

Move my existing files into the appropriate folders. Don't delete anything. Then create a CLAUDE.md file in the root that describes what's in each folder.

**You don't have to use these exact names.** Use names that make sense to you. The point is: different things go in different folders, and each folder gets a CLAUDE.md that says what it's for.

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## Step 4: Create Your Global CLAUDE.md (5 minutes)

If you don't have a global CLAUDE.md, say this to Claude:

I need a global CLAUDE.md file at ~/.claude/CLAUDE.md. This should contain:

- My name: [your name]
- What I do: [one sentence about your business]
- My AI workspace is at: [path to your organized folder from Step 3]
- My preferences: Don't ask permission for file operations. Write progress to files, not just chat. When you read a document I give you, confirm what you read.

Keep it short. Under 50 lines. I can add more later.

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## Step 5: Point Claude to Your Organized Folder (1 minute)

From now on, when you start a Claude session, point it to your new organized root folder (the one from Step 3), not a subfolder inside it.

- **In Claude Desktop (Code mode):** Select your root folder when it asks
- **In Terminal:** `cd ~/Documents/[YourName]-AI && claude`
- **In Obsidian:** Open that folder as a vault, then run Claude from inside it

When Claude starts, it will read the CLAUDE.md at the root and immediately know where everything is.

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## What This Changes

**Before:** Claude starts cold every session. Doesn't know who you are. Can't find your files. Asks permission for everything. You have to re-explain everything every time.

**After:** Claude reads your global CLAUDE.md (knows your preferences), enters your workspace, reads the folder-level CLAUDE.md (knows where everything is), and gets to work. You pick up where you left off.

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## Common Questions

**Q: Do I need Obsidian for this?**

No. Obsidian is optional. It's a nice visual layer on top of your files, but Claude doesn't care if you use Obsidian, Finder, or the terminal. What matters is that your files are organized and have CLAUDE.md files.

**Q: What if I already have files everywhere?**

Tell Claude to help you reorganize. It can scan your folder, propose a structure, and move files for you. Just make sure your "never delete" permission rule is set first.

**Q: Do I need a CLAUDE.md in every single folder?**

Not every folder. Start with your root folder and each major subfolder (projects, resources, etc.). You can add more later as needed. Think of it like labels on filing cabinet drawers -- not every paper needs a label, but each drawer should have one.

**Q: My .claude folder has skills from the course but they're in the wrong place (inside my project folder instead of ~/.claude/skills/). What do I do?**

Tell Claude: "I have skills in [current location]. Move them to ~/.claude/skills/ where they belong, and make sure they still work."

**Q: How is this different from what Rich showed us?**

Rich has 196 skills, dozens of agents, and a deep folder hierarchy built over months. You don't need any of that right now. What you need is the foundation: organized folders, CLAUDE.md context files, and proper permissions. Everything Rich builds sits on top of this exact foundation.

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## The 25-Minute Checklist

- ☐ Step 1: Check .claude folder (5 min)
- ☐ Step 2: Set permissions (2 min)
- ☐ Step 3: Organize files into folders (15 min)
- ☐ Step 4: Create global CLAUDE.md (5 min)

☐ Step 5: Point Claude to your root folder (1 min)

Do these five steps and your next Claude session will be dramatically different from your last one.